

KYLE GAARDER

Program Manager | Community Support | Cross-Functional Ops

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SUMMARY

Community-focused program designer with hands-on experience building support systems, conflict resolution frameworks, and cross-functional programs from scratch. I design programs that bridge operations, community, and product - measuring success by engagement, retention, and stakeholder satisfaction. My background in coliving gives me deep empathy for host and guest dynamics.

EXPERIENCE

Founder, Product & Operations

Revillage Coliving

📅 08/2022 - 07/2024 📍 Austin, TX

- Launched an 8-bedroom coliving property in 2 weeks, reaching 100% occupancy before lease start
- Designed conflict-resolution and communication systems supporting long-term resident satisfaction
- Ran 48 community programs, 4 masterminds, and 6 work-trade programs driving engagement and retention
- Built cross-functional workflows across ops, community, and product to improve resident experience
- Maintained 94% occupancy for 19 months through program-driven retention and community design
- Directed full-cycle operations, improving efficiency 212% YoY across all functional areas
- Facilitated smooth acquisition transition to Macro House while maintaining stakeholder relationships

Co-Founder, Strategy & Operations

Van Village

📅 01/2021 - 08/2022 📍 Portland, OR

- Built demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through grassroots community outreach
- Conducted 48 customer interviews to understand user needs and guide program design
- Explored partnerships across 5 states and personally secured an investor-backed pilot program
- Led cross-functional execution across strategy, ops, and product in early-stage environment

Co-Founder, Operations & Growth

Lake Barcroft Boats

📅 01/2011 - 01/2016 📍 Falls Church, VA

- Built a niche service business from zero to 140+ clients
- Achieved 82% customer retention through relationship-driven service
- Generated 46% year-over-year revenue growth by improving pricing, operations, and service offerings
- Personally closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach and referrals
- Managed scheduling, pricing, contractors, and customer relationships across 230+ completed service contracts

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- 💎 **Community Program Portfolio**
Designed and ran 48 dinners, 4 masterminds, and 6 work-trade programs from scratch
- 💎 **Conflict Resolution Systems**
Built conflict-resolution and communication frameworks supporting long-term satisfaction
- 💎 **94% Retention via Programs**
Program-driven retention sustained 94% occupancy for 19 months in emerging housing model
- 💎 **Investor Pilot Secured**
Sourced and secured an investor-backed pilot for a new community concept across 5 states
- 💎 **Demand Pipeline Built**
Built early demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through concept validation and outreach

SKILLS

Program Management	
Community Support Design	
Cross-Functional Execution	
Conflict Resolution	
Stakeholder Management	KPIs
User Research	Interviews
Partnerships	Market Creation

EDUCATION

Bachelors in Science, Biology	
Virginia Tech	GPA 3.5 / 4.0
📅 08/2010 - 05/2014	
📍 Virginia, USA	
• Minors in Psychology, International Studies, Spanish	